



From March 10-14, 2026, the Visual Arts Gallery at the India Habitat Centre in New Delhi hosted *A Voyage to Permanence*, an immersive exhibition centred on three experimental films by filmmaker Purandar Chaudhuri. Presented by gallerist and art consultant Jooby Yohannan and curated by art historian Johny M.L., the project reimagined how cinema might be experienced within a gallery setting.

At the heart of the exhibition are Chaudhuri's films *Dhushor*, *Tremors*, and *Impressions of Mingling*. Exploring themes of memory, migration, erasure and survival, the works unfold through a contemplative visual language. As Johny M.L. notes, the films are not intended to "flag out the issues of migration or self-degeneration and regeneration caused by various forces". Instead, they function as aesthetic contemplations in which "memories of traditional analogue movie-making are evoked along with their digital possibilities", allowing cinematic language to oscillate between abstraction and figuration.



Chaudhuri describes his filmmaking as an attempt to move beyond conventional narrative structures. He explains that he makes films that break "the conventional rules of movie-making", likening them to "memory catchers" that require "a different sensibility to see and feel the memories". Each work becomes "a tribute to the human exodus and survival", reflecting the "cruel alchemy" through which the human body is transformed into labour.

Underlying the three films are two moods that shape their visual language: melancholy and wandering. The melancholy that permeates Chaudhuri's imagery recalls what novelist Orhan Pamuk calls *hüzün*, a reflective sadness sharpened by an awareness of the fragile nuances of human life. At the same time, Chaudhuri's gaze resists detached urban observation, turning instead toward those often unseen within city life. Migrant bodies, movement and displacement emerge as recurring motifs, suggesting that the passage of human lives through memory and labour is itself a voyage toward permanence. ■

—Nikhil Sardana

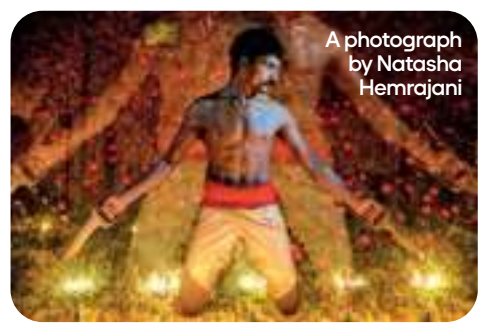
Following New Delhi, the exhibition will travel to Alliance Française of Madras in August and the Museum of Goa in September

phasises this very fact," says Meghna Mathew, a member of the organising team. "We treat venues and activity centres agnostically," Mathew explains, noting that the festival allows different formats and audiences to intersect across spaces.

Drawing from the Delhi chapter, the team has planned niche engagements such as walkthroughs of private collections—including a collector's home that houses around 1,500 carpets—as well as sessions at cultural spaces. ■

—Deepa Natarajan Lobo

Bengaluru Art Weekend will be held from Mar. 28 to Apr. 6



A photograph by Natasha Hemrajani

PHOTOGRAPHY ▲

VISUAL FEAST

An exhibition of images by leading travel photographers shows Kerala in a new light

The subjects may be familiar Kerala tropes—backwaters, kalaripayattu—but interpretation is everything. And when you have 75 stunning shots by 10 leading travel photographers, curated by art curator Uma Nair, you know it's going to be a visual feast. *Lenscape Kerala*, a show that was inaugurated by photographer Sooni Taraporevala at Mumbai's Jehangir Art Gallery in February, will be on view in other cities.

Travel photographers Aishwarya Sridhar, Amit Pasricha, H. Satish, Kounteya Sinha, Manoj Arora, Natasha Hemrajani, Saibal Das, Saurabh Chatterjee, Shivang Mehta and Umesh Gogna, led by wildlife and conservation photographer Balan Madhavan, travelled through Kerala in December and came away with new perspectives. "All these photographers come with their own understanding of light and shadow," explains Nair. "The most compelling part was the discovery of their own passion and the odysseys they revealed." ■

—Priya Pathiyan

After Hyderabad (Mar. 12-14), Lenscape Kerala will travel to Surat (Mar. 19-21) and Kolkata (Mar. 27-29)